Tap Targets

In short

Buttons and links need to be big enough to press without touching something else by mistake. This helps people with shaky hands, or using a phone on a bus or train. Aim for at least 48 by 48 pixels, with a gap of 8 pixels between them.

What is it for?

You should ensure that interactive elements like buttons or links are large enough and have enough space around them, to make them easy to press without accidentally overlapping onto other elements.

Small tap targets can cause rage clicks, where the user has to try to click on an interactive element more than once. Larger tap targets can remove barriers for a number of users, including (but not limited to):

- Users who use a mobile device where a touchscreen is the primary mode of interaction
- Users with mobility impairments, such as hand tremors
- Users who use a mobile device in environments where they are exposed to shaking, such as public transportation
- Users who find fine motor movements difficult
- Users who access a device using one hand
- Users with large fingers, or who are operating the device with only a part of their finger or knuckle
- Users who have low vision may better see the target

You don't need any special code for this. Just make sure your tap targets are large enough, with enough of a gap between them.

How to support it

Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.2 requires tap targets to be at least 24px x 24px at Level AA (SC 2.5.8 Target Size (Minimum)), unless there's enough space around them. At Level AAA, they must be at least 44px x 44px (SC 2.5.5 Target

Size (Enhanced)). This is so that a user's finger pressing on one tap target does not inadvertently touch another tap target.

*Note:* `px` _*means*_ `pixels`

Google's Material Design recommends a minimum tap target size of 48px x 48px, with a gap of at least 8px between tap targets. This is larger than the minimum required by WCAG.

The 48px x 48px area corresponds to around 9mm, which is about the size of a person's finger pad area.

Any interactive element (unless it's text links within a paragraph) should be designed and built to be a minimum size of 48px x 48px, with a gap of 8px between any tap targets.

```
button {
    min-width: 48px;
    min-height: 48px;
    margin: 8px;
}
```

While an icon contained by a link may only have a width and height of 24px, you can add padding to the link to bring the tap target size up to 48px.

```
a {
    display: inline-block;
    margin: 8px;
    padding: 12px;
}
```

Useful links

- Understanding SC 2.5.8: Target Size (Minimum)
- How to use typography, touch targets, and spacing for better accessibility
- Accessible tap targets cheat sheet